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# Lecture 8

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## Chapter 2. Basic Structures

1. Sets
2. Set Operations

# Sets so far...

- Previously...

- Literal set  $\{a, b, c\}$  and set-builder notation  $\{x \mid P(x)\}$
- Basic properties: unordered, distinct elements
- infinite sets  $\mathbf{N}$ ,  $\mathbf{Z}$ ,  $\mathbf{Z}^+$ ,  $\mathbf{Q}$ ,  $\mathbf{R}$

- Today

- $\in$  relational operator, and the empty set  $\emptyset$
- Venn diagrams
- Set relations  $=$ ,  $\subseteq$ ,  $\subset$ ,  $\supset$ ,  $\not\subset$ , etc.
- Cardinality  $|S|$  of a set  $S$
- Power sets  $P(S)$
- Cartesian product  $S \times T$
- Set operators:  $\cup$ ,  $\cap$ ,  $-$

# Basic Set Relations: Member of

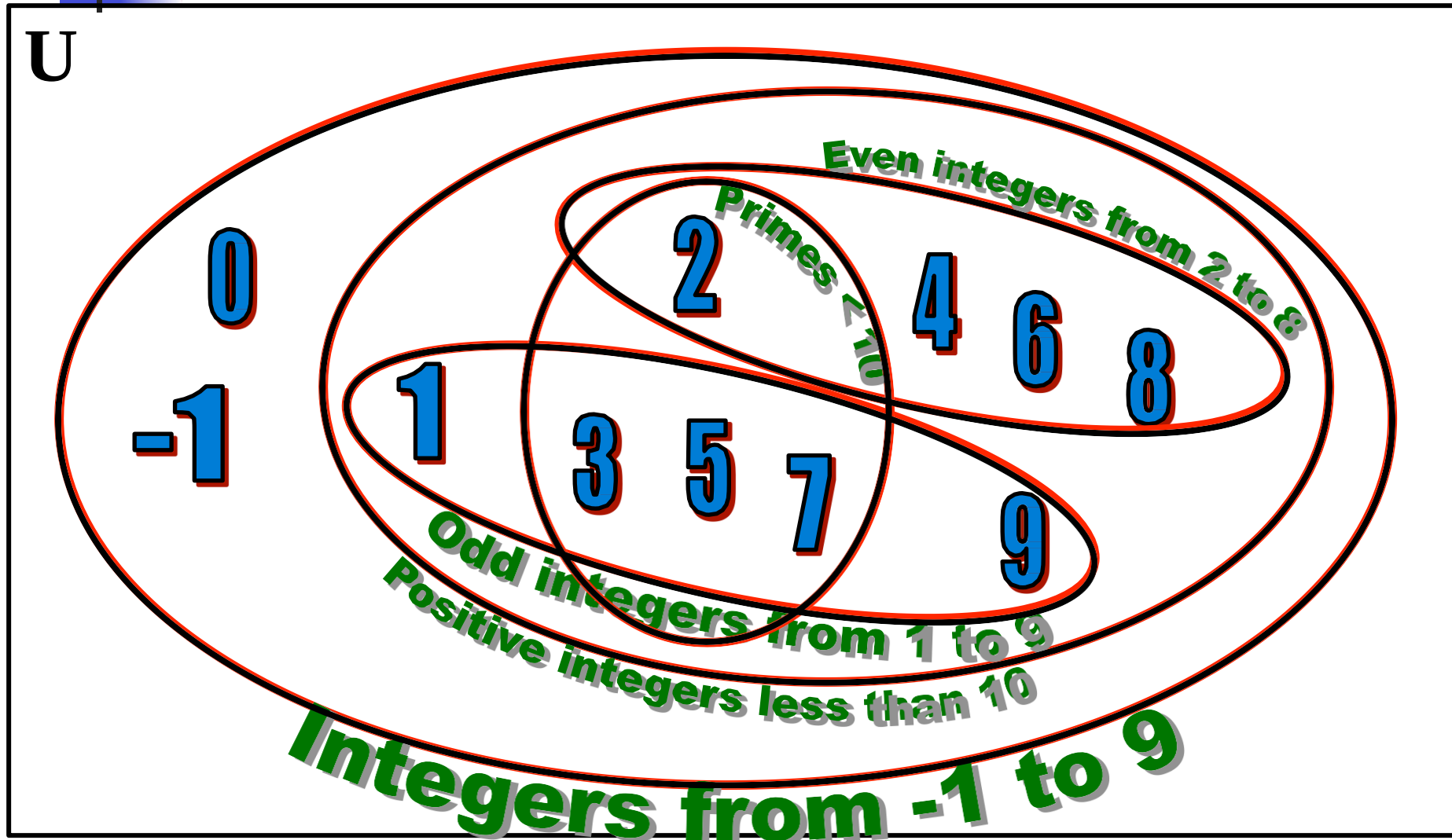
- $x \in S$  (“ $x$  is in  $S$ ”) is the proposition that object  $x$  is an *element* or *member* of set  $S$ .
  - e.g.  $3 \in \mathbf{N}$ ,  
 $a \in \{x \mid x \text{ is a letter of the alphabet}\}$
  - Can define set equality in terms of  $\in$  relation:  
$$\forall S, T: S = T \leftrightarrow [\forall x (x \in S \leftrightarrow x \in T)]$$

“Two sets are equal iff they have all the same members.”
- $x \notin S \equiv \neg(x \in S)$       “ $x$  is not in  $S$ ”

# The Empty Set

- $\emptyset$  (“null”, “the empty set”) is the unique set that contains no elements whatsoever.
- $\emptyset = \{ \} = \{x \mid \mathbf{False}\}$
- No matter the domain of discourse, we have the axiom  $\neg \exists x: x \in \emptyset$ .
- $\{ \} \neq \{ \emptyset \} = \{ \{ \} \}$ 
  - $\{ \emptyset \}$  it isn't empty because it has  $\emptyset$  as a member!

# Venn Diagrams

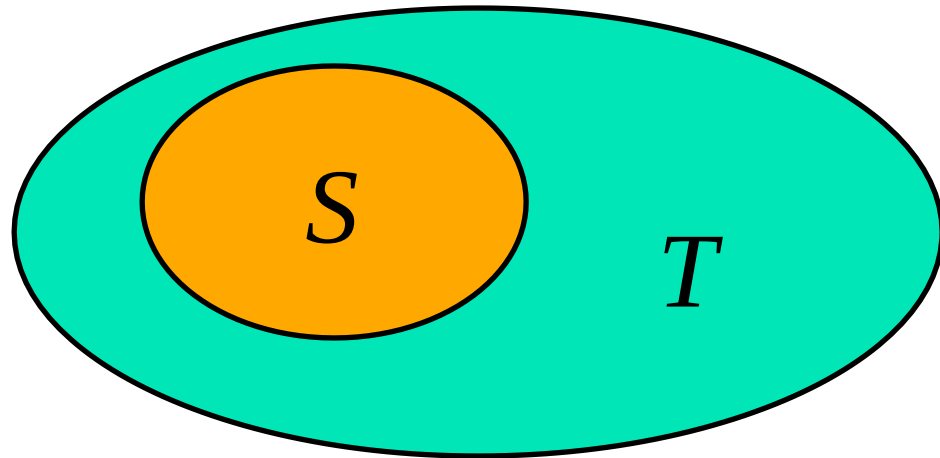


# Subset and Superset

- $S \subseteq T$  (“ $S$  is a subset of  $T$ ”) means that every element of  $S$  is also an element of  $T$ .
- $S \subseteq T \equiv \forall x (x \in S \rightarrow x \in T)$
- $\emptyset \subseteq S, S \subseteq S$
- $S \subseteq T$  (“ $S$  is a superset of  $T$ ”) means  $T \subseteq S$
- Note  $(S = T) \equiv (S \subseteq T \wedge T \subseteq S)$   
 $\equiv \forall x (x \in S \rightarrow x \in T) \wedge \forall x (x \in T \rightarrow x \in S)$   
 $\equiv \forall x (x \in S \leftrightarrow x \in T)$
- $S \not\subseteq T$  means  $\neg(S \subseteq T)$ , i.e.  $\exists x (x \in S \wedge x \notin T)$

# Proper (Strict) Subsets & Supersets

- $S \subset T$  (“ $S$  is a proper subset of  $T$ ”) means that  $S \subseteq T$  but  $T \not\subseteq S$ . Similar for  $S \supset T$ .
- Example:  
 $\{1, 2\} \subset \{1, 2, 3\}$



Venn Diagram of  $S \subset T$

# Sets Are Objects, Too!

- The objects that are elements of a set may *themselves* be sets.

- Example:

Let  $S = \{x \mid x \subseteq \{1, 2, 3\}\}$

then  $S = \{ \emptyset,$

$\{1\}, \{2\}, \{3\},$

$\{1, 2\}, \{1, 3\}, \{2, 3\},$

$\{1, 2, 3\} \}$

- Note that  $1 \neq \{1\} \neq \{\{1\}\} !!!!$

 **Very Important!**



# Cardinality and Finiteness

- $|S|$  (read “the *cardinality* of  $S$ ”) is a measure of how many different elements  $S$  has.
- *E.g.*,  $|\emptyset| = 0$ ,  $|\{1, 2, 3\}| = 3$ ,  $|\{a, b\}| = 2$ ,  
 $|\{\{1, 2, 3\}, \{4, 5\}\}| = \underline{2}$
- If  $|S| \in \mathbf{N}$ , then we say  $S$  is *finite*.  
Otherwise, we say  $S$  is *infinite*.
- What are some infinite sets we’ve seen?

**N, Z, Q, R**

# The *Power Set* Operation

- The **power set**  $P(S)$  of a set  $S$  is the set of all subsets of  $S$ .  $P(S) = \{x \mid x \subseteq S\}$ .
- Examples
  - $P(\{a, b\}) = \{ \emptyset, \{a\}, \{b\}, \{a, b\} \}$
  - $S = \{0, 1, 2\}$   
 $P(S) = \{ \emptyset, \{0\}, \{1\}, \{2\}, \{0, 1\}, \{0, 2\}, \{1, 2\}, \{0, 1, 2\} \}$
  - $P(\emptyset) = \{ \emptyset \}$
  - $P(\{ \emptyset \}) = \{ \emptyset, \{ \emptyset \} \}$
- Note that for finite  $S$ ,  $|P(S)| = 2^{|S|}$ .
- It turns out  $\forall S (|P(S)| > |S|)$ , e.g.  $|P(\mathbb{N})| > |\mathbb{N}|$ .

# Ordered $n$ -tuples

- These are like sets, except that duplicates matter, and the order makes a difference.
- For  $n \in \mathbf{N}$ , an *ordered  $n$ -tuple* or a *sequence* or *list of length  $n$*  is written  $(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$ . Its *first* element is  $a_1$ , its *second* element is  $a_2$ , *etc.*
- Note that  $(1, 2) \neq (2, 1) \neq (2, 1, 1)$ . ← Contrast with sets'  $\{\}$
- Empty sequence, singlets, pairs, triples, quadruples, quintuples,  $\dots$ ,  $n$ -tuples.

# Cartesian Products of Sets

- For sets  $A$  and  $B$ , their **Cartesian product** denoted by  $A \times B$ , is the set of all ordered pairs  $(a, b)$ , where  $a \in A$  and  $b \in B$ . Hence,

$$A \times B = \{ (a, b) \mid a \in A \wedge b \in B \}.$$

- E.g.  $\{a, b\} \times \{1, 2\}$   
 $= \{ (a, 1), (a, 2), (b, 1), (b, 2) \}$

- Note that for finite  $A, B$ ,  $|A \times B| = |A||B|$ .
- Note that the Cartesian product is **not** commutative: i.e.,  $\neg \forall A, B (A \times B = B \times A)$ .
- Extends to  $A_1 \times A_2 \times \dots \times A_n$   
 $= \{ (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) \mid a_i \in A_i \text{ for } i = 1, 2, \dots, n \}$

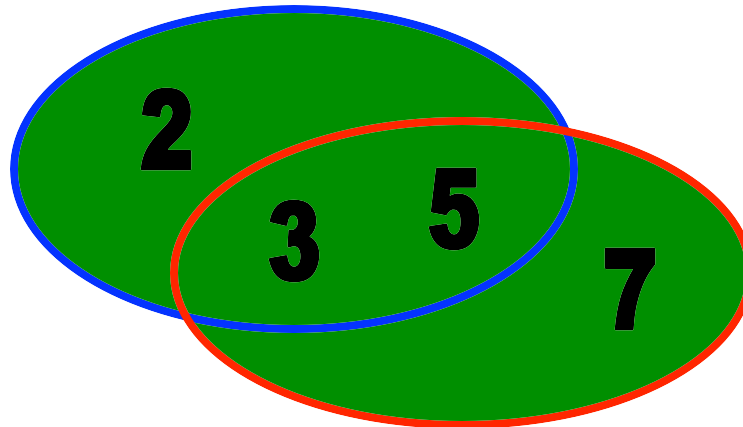
# The Union Operator

- For sets  $A$  and  $B$ , their **union**  $A \cup B$  is the set containing all elements that are either in  $A$ , **or** (“ $\vee$ ”) in  $B$  (or, of course, in both).
- Formally,  $\forall A, B: A \cup B = \{x \mid x \in A \vee x \in B\}$ .
- Note that  $A \cup B$  is a **superset** of both  $A$  and  $B$  (in fact, it is the smallest such superset):  
$$\forall A, B: (A \cup B \subseteq A) \wedge (A \cup B \subseteq B)$$

# Union Examples

- $\{a, b, c\} \cup \{2, 3\} = \{a, b, c, 2, 3\}$
- $\{2, 3, 5\} \cup \{3, 5, 7\} = \{2, 3, 5, 3, 5, 7\}$   
 $= \{2, 3, 5, 7\}$

Required Form



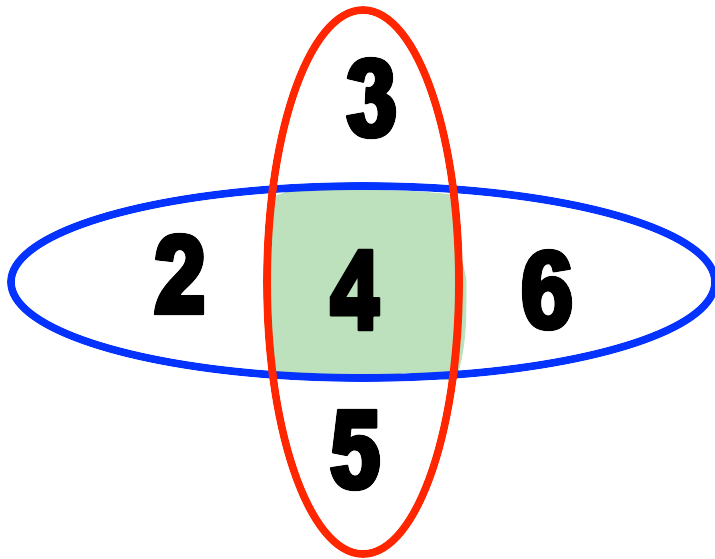
# The Intersection Operator

- For sets  $A$  and  $B$ , their ***intersection***  $A \cap B$  is the set containing all elements that are simultaneously in  $A$  **and** (“ $\wedge$ ”) in  $B$ .
- Formally,  $\forall A, B: A \cap B = \{x \mid x \in A \wedge x \in B\}$ .
- Note that  $A \cap B$  is a **subset** of both  $A$  and  $B$  (in fact it is the largest such subset):

$$\forall A, B: (A \cap B \subseteq A) \wedge (A \cap B \subseteq B)$$

# Intersection Examples

- $\{a, b, c\} \cap \{2, 3\} = \underline{\emptyset}$
- $\{2, 4, 6\} \cap \{3, 4, 5\} = \underline{\{4\}}$



Think “The **intersection** of University Ave. and Dole St. is just that part of the road surface that lies on *both* streets.”



# Disjointedness

- Two sets  $A$ ,  $B$  are called **disjoint** (i.e., unjoined) iff their intersection is empty. ( $A \cap B = \emptyset$ )
- Example: the set of even integers is disjoint with the set of odd integers.



# Inclusion-Exclusion Principle

- How many elements are in  $A \cup B$ ?

$$|A \cup B| = |A| + |B| - |A \cap B|$$

- Example: How many students in the class major in Computer Science or Mathematics?

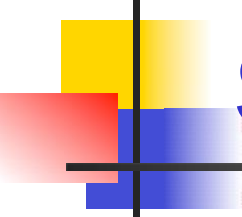
- Consider set  $E = C \cup M$ ,

$C = \{s \mid s \text{ is a Computer Science major}\}$

$M = \{s \mid s \text{ is a Mathematics major}\}$

- Some students are joint majors!

$$|E| = |C \cup M| = |C| + |M| - |C \cap M|$$

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# Set Difference

- For sets  $A$  and  $B$ , the ***difference of  $A$  and  $B$*** , written  $A - B$ , is the set of all elements that are in  $A$  but not  $B$ .

- Formally:

$$\begin{aligned} A - B &= \{x \mid x \in A \wedge x \notin B\} \\ &= \{x \mid \neg(x \in A \rightarrow x \in B)\} \end{aligned}$$

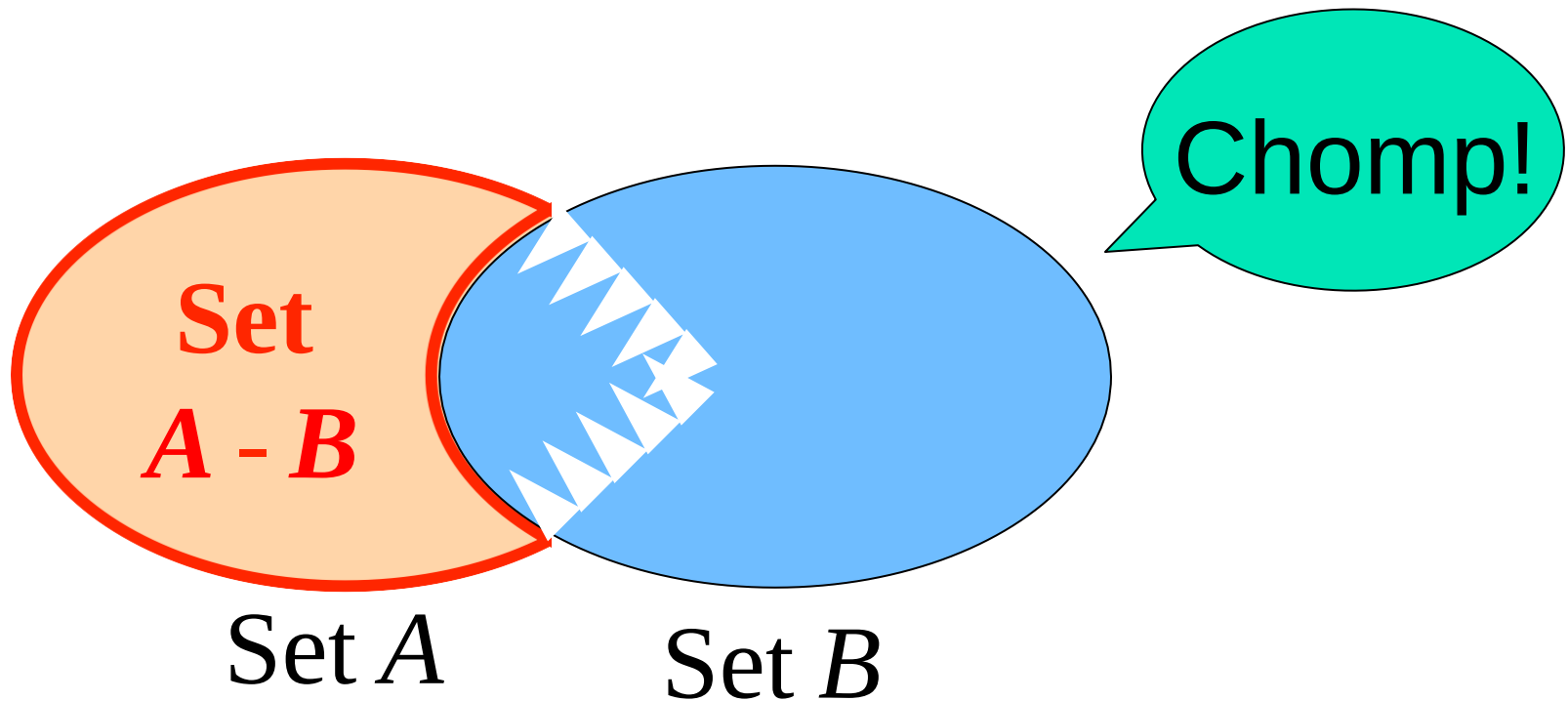
- Also called:

The ***complement of  $B$  with respect to  $A$*** .

# Set Difference: Venn Diagram

- $A - B$

is what's left after  $B$  “takes a bite out of  $A$ ”



# Set Difference Examples

$$\bullet \quad \{ \textcircled{1}, \textcircled{2}, \textcircled{3}, \textcircled{4}, \textcircled{5}, \textcircled{6} \} - \{2, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11\} = \underline{\{1, 4, 6\}}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \bullet \quad \mathbb{Z} - \mathbb{N} &= \{ \dots, -1, 0, 1, 2, \dots \} - \{0, 1, \dots \} \\ &= \{x \mid x \text{ is an integer but not a natural } \#\} \\ &= \{ \dots, -3, -2, -1 \} \\ &= \{x \mid x \text{ is a negative integer} \} \end{aligned}$$

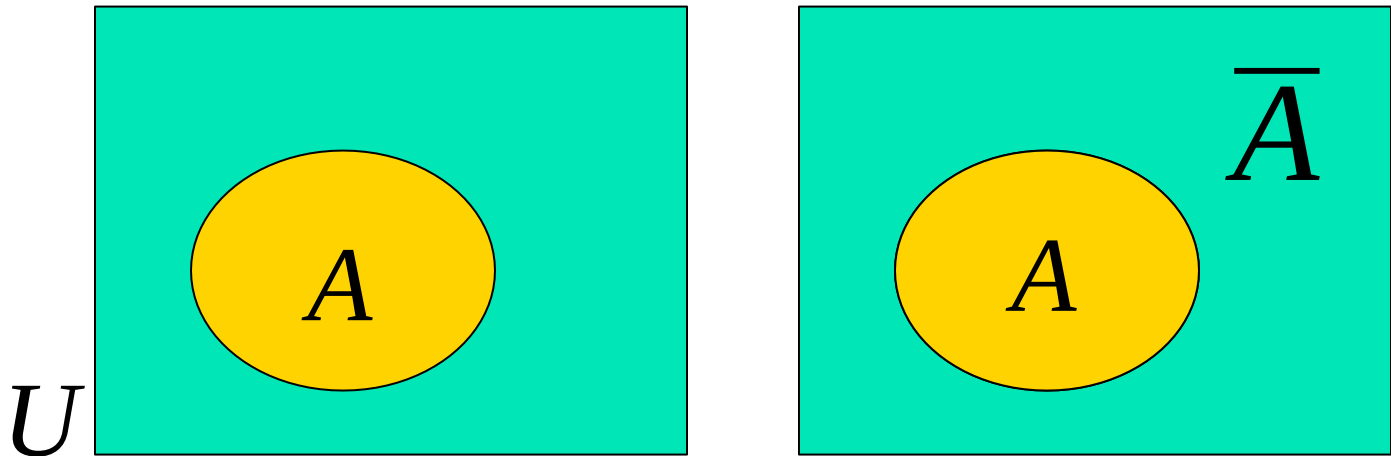
# Set Complements

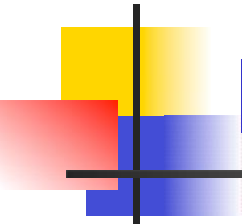
- The *universe of discourse* (or the *domain*) can itself be considered a set, call it  $U$ .
- When the context clearly defines  $U$ , we say that for any set  $A \subseteq U$ , the **complement** of  $A$ , written as  $\overline{A}$ , is the complement of  $A$  with respect to  $U$ , *i.e.*, it is  $U - A$ .
- *E.g.*, If  $U = \mathbf{N}$ ,  
$$\overline{\{3, 5\}} = \{0, 1, 2, 4, 6, 7, \dots\}$$

# More on Set Complements

- An equivalent definition, when  $U$  is obvious:

$$\overline{A} = \{x \mid x \notin A\}$$



A decorative graphic in the top left corner consisting of overlapping yellow, red, and blue squares with a black crosshair.

# Interval Notation

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- $a, b \in \mathbf{R}$ , and  $a < b$  then
  - $(a, b) = \{x \in \mathbf{R} \mid a < x < b\}$
  - $[a, b] = \{x \in \mathbf{R} \mid a \leq x \leq b\}$
  - $(a, b] = \{x \in \mathbf{R} \mid a < x \leq b\}$
  - $(-\infty, b] = \{x \in \mathbf{R} \mid x \leq b\}$
  - $[a, \infty) = \{x \in \mathbf{R} \mid a \leq x\}$
  - $(a, \infty) = \{x \in \mathbf{R} \mid a < x\}$